

PRACTICUM IN CYBERSECURITY

2026 – 2027 · COURSE SYLLABUS & PRACTICUM AGREEMENT



TWO CREDITS · ROOM 2115 · CAPSTONE EXPERIENCE · PRACTICUM IN INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY

INSTRUCTOR

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CLASS WEBSITE

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HOW TO READ THIS

Every section below is tagged with who sets the rule: the State of Texas, Leander ISD, Vista Ridge, or this classroom.

WELCOME

SET BY
MR. MORALES

Welcome to your practicum year. This is the capstone of the cybersecurity pathway. You take the skills you built in the classroom and apply them in a real setting, where real people depend on the work being done right.

I am looking forward to watching you grow this year, and I am readily available to help. Ask questions early and often. Go Rangers.

MR. MORALES'S PRO TIP

Finish your work during class. Then you walk out with nothing hanging over you: no homework, full credit on the assignment, and you come back ready for the next topic.

COURSE OVERVIEW

SET BY
TEXAS TEKS

Practicum in Cybersecurity gives you supervised, practical application of what you have already studied plus new knowledge and skills you pick up on the job. Practicum experiences happen in a variety of locations appropriate to the nature and level of the work.

Units are not delivered in order. You may demonstrate a skill set at any point during the practicum, as long as you meet the time expectations for the experience.

This is a two-credit course and the capstone of your cybersecurity sequence. It carries the standards for **Practicum in Information Technology**.

ALIGNED TO [**Texas CTE TEKS, Chapter 127**](#)

WHAT TO BRING

SET BY
THIS CLASSROOM

- › A laptop. Bring the charger and a mouse.
- › A way to take notes. Bring something to write with and something to write on.
- › Anything your training site requires. We will sort this out together before you start.

Need help getting supplies? Contact me. No student goes without.

STUDENT
EXPECTATIONS

SET BY
THIS CLASSROOM

These are simple, and every one of them transfers to whatever workplace you end up in.

- › **Be on time.** Be in your seat and ready when the bell rings. School policy applies to late arrivals.
- › **Be prepared.** Bring your materials every day and have completed work ready at the start of class. Submit Google Classroom assignments on time.
- › **Participate.** Listen during lectures, join the activities, ask real questions.
- › **Manage your time.** Complete and submit every assignment by its due date.
- › **Own your learning, earn your grade.** Try your best, learn from your mistakes, and ask for help when you need it.
- › **Respect others.** Treat classmates, teachers, staff, and substitutes with kindness. Listen when someone else is speaking. Bullying and harassment are not tolerated.
- › **Watch your language.** Swearing, insults, and derogatory comments have no place here.
- › **Respect property.** Take care of the furniture, equipment, and materials. Do not deface or damage anything, and clean up after yourself and your classmates.

PHONES & DEVICES

SET BY
STATE OF TEXAS

Under **House Bill 1481**, phones and other personal electronic devices, including smart watches, tablets, gaming devices, and headphones or earbuds with cellular connectivity, may not be used on campus between 8:05 AM and 3:35 PM. That includes restrooms, hallways, and lunch. Make electronic MINGA hall passes on a computer.

Devices stay **away and unseen** in your backpack or bag. Not on your person, not in a pocket, not in a waistband. If you do not carry a bag, leave your device in the AP office.

- FIRST INCIDENT** Warning and contact home
- SECOND INCIDENT** Referral to your AP

Repeated violations can mean a parent or guardian picks the device up from VRHS, and you may lose the privilege of bringing one to school. Continued violations follow the Vista Ridge and Leander ISD Student Code of Conduct. Remember that this is state law.

IF EXPECTATIONS
ARE NOT MET

SET BY
THIS CLASSROOM

You are here to learn. It is your job to do your best, participate, and collaborate. If you choose to use class time for something else:

- FIRST TIME** Verbal warning
- SECOND TIME** Warning and parent contact
- THIRD TIME** Office referral

Severe disruption, or any violation of a safety or security protocol, is an immediate office referral.

REQUIRED TASKS

SET BY
THIS CLASSROOM

We will work out the detail of each of these together.

- › Safety and industry certifications. CareerSafe StartSafe to begin, plus others we identify for your pathway.
- › College exploration and presentation. Cybersecurity and IT programs.
- › Career exploration and presentation. Roles across the cybersecurity field.
- › Career practicum. Your supervised work at an approved training site.
- › Career portfolio. Evidence of what you built, secured, and learned.
- › Anything else we brainstorm together.

HOW GRADES WORK

SET BY
LEANDER ISD

The general category is below. Each cycle the weighting may change based on the unit of study. Check the category percentage for each cycle in Home Access Center.

DAILY WORK & PROJECTS.....100%

LATE WORK & REDOS

SET BY
THIS CLASSROOM

Work is due during your scheduled class period. Anything turned in after that is late and can earn a **maximum score of 80**.

Late work can still be redone. You may need to finish steps I assign first, such as attending tutorials or making corrections. A redo replaces your score with up to an 80, and if you already scored above an 80 that grade stands. You have a one-week window.

Turn in all work and final redos at least one week before grades are due at the end of the grading period.

MISSED WORK & ABSENCES

SET BY
LEANDER ISD

If you are absent for any reason, check in with me the day you return so we can set your make-up assignments, their due dates, and the dates you will take any missed quizzes or exams. You get one day of make-up time for every day you were out, so two days absent means two days to make up. On the A/B schedule, one day means one class period. Two exceptions: work already assigned and due on the day you were absent is due the day you return, and a quiz or exam already scheduled for that day is given the day you return.

ABSENT FOR AN EXTRACURRICULAR

Get your assignments before you go. Turn missed work in on your first day back, during non-class time, and arrange that time with me ahead of it.

ACADEMIC HONESTY

SET BY
VISTA RIDGE HS

Academic dishonesty is not tolerated. If you cheat or help someone else cheat, including sharing completed work through Google Drive, the offense is documented, your parent or guardian is contacted, and a referral goes to the AP office for your record.

- › **First offense on daily work.** Automatic zero.
- › **First offense on an exam or project.** Redo the work for a maximum score of 50, or accept the zero.
- › **Habitual offenses.** Zero regardless of assignment weight, and loss of all exemption privileges.

Plagiarism is copying from any source, including AI, websites, books, and classmates, or presenting ideas that did not originate with you. Sources are a good thing when you credit them properly.

Cybersecurity runs entirely on trust, and in this field your word is the credential.

TUTORIALS & HELP

SET BY
THIS CLASSROOM

TUESDAY THROUGH THURSDAY · A DAYS AND B DAYS

BEFORE SCHOOL 7:30 – 8:00 AM · Room 2115

AFTER SCHOOL 3:35 – 4:05 PM · Room 2115

RANGER TIME

I will have open tutorial times on movement days for Ranger Time.

PRACTICUM AGREEMENT

SET BY
LEANDER ISD

CAREER AND TECHNICAL EDUCATION

A practicum is a capstone experience. It gives you supervised, practical application of what you learned across a full sequence of courses, lets you explore careers, and moves you toward work in the field.

For this course to work, students and parents or guardians need to understand and agree to the terms below. Good work habits start with everyone following the same departmental standards.

- 1** You may be employed at a teacher-approved training site under a paid or unpaid training plan agreement. You should not work under the direct supervision of a relative.
- 2** You must be at least a junior, be 16 years of age by the first day of school, and have valid work documentation such as a government-issued identification card.
- 3** All district policies on student grooming and behavior apply while you are at the training site, at school, or at any program function.
- 4** Contact me and your training sponsor any time you will not be in class or on the job.
- 5** Anything you see at your training site stays there. Systems, data, credentials, vulnerabilities, and incidents are confidential. Do not photograph, copy, post, or discuss them outside the site without written permission from your sponsor.
- 6** Parents and guardians should understand your responsibility to the training station and not plan to pull you from work for visits or vacations. Bring concerns about the training site to me rather than to the training sponsor.
- 7** You provide your own transportation to and from your practicum experience.

- 8 If you are not at the training site during periods assigned for training, you may not leave the high school campus without my written approval in advance. Being found off campus without that approval may result in administrative due process.
- 9 You must maintain satisfactory academic standing and tell me about anything that could affect your training or your schoolwork. I recommend limiting work to 25 hours per week, excluding weekends.
- 10 You stay at the same training site for the entire school year. Quitting an approved training site without my prior approval earns a grade of zero for the work portion of that grading period.
- 11 Being dismissed by your training sponsor for sufficient reason earns a grade of zero for the work portion of that grading period.
- 12 In the community you represent Vista Ridge High School. Misconduct at a training site is a matter of school policy during the school year. Your teacher, your sponsor, and the school expect excellent conduct.
- 13 Signing this form is consent for you to take part in all program activities and permission to leave school to do so.
- 14 Do not accept or place personal phone calls while at your training site.
- 15 Family and friends are not to visit you at your training site.

SIGN & RETURN

SET BY
LEANDER ISD

RETURN THIS PAGE TO MR. MORALES DURING THE FIRST WEEK OF CLASS

I have read the statements above and I agree to comply.

I understand that failure to follow these rules may result in loss of credit and removal from the course. It may also result in disciplinary action requiring me to stay on campus until the end of the regular school day, and may result in loss of the early release privilege.

STUDENT

PRINTED NAME _____

SIGNATURE _____

PHONE _____

DATE _____

PARENT OR GUARDIAN

PRINTED NAME _____

SIGNATURE _____

PHONE _____

DATE _____

LISD CTE NON-DISCRIMINATION STATEMENT

Leander ISD does not discriminate on the basis of race, color, national origin, sex, or disability in its programs or activities and provides equal access to the Boy Scouts and other designated youth groups. The following person has been designated to handle inquiries regarding the nondiscrimination policies: Bryan Miller, Title IX Coordinator; 204 W. South Street Leander, TX 78646; Bryan.Miller@Leanderisd.org; (512) 570-0000.

Leander ISD no discrimina por motivos de raza, color, origen nacional, sexo o discapacidad en sus programas o actividades y proporciona igualdad de acceso a los Boy Scouts y otros grupos juveniles designados. La siguiente persona ha sido designada para atender las consultas relacionadas con las políticas de no discriminación: Bryan Miller, Coordinador del Título IX; 204 W. South Street Leander, TX 78646; Bryan.Miller@Leanderisd.org; (512) 570-0000.

Leander ISD తన కార్యక్రమాలు లేదా కార్యకలాపాలలో జాతి, వర్ణం, జాతీయ జన్మ మూలం, లింగం లేదా వైకల్యం ఆధారంగా వివక్షను చూపించదు మరియు బాలుర స్కౌట్లు మరియు ఇతర హోదా కల నియమిత యువజన సమూహాలకు సమాన ప్రాప్యతను అందిస్తుంది. వివక్షారహిత పాలసీలకు సంబంధించిన విచారణలను చేపట్టడం కోసం ఈ క్రింది వ్యక్తి నియమితులయ్యారు: Bryan Miller, టైటిల్ IX కోఆర్డినేటర్; 204 W. South Street Leander, TX 78646; Bryan.Miller@Leanderisd.org; (512) 570-0000.

Leander ISD 는 프로그램이나 활동에서 인종, 피부색, 국적, 성별 또는 장애를 이유로 차별하지 않으며 보이스카우트 및 기타 지정된 청소년 단체에 동등한 접근 권한을 제공합니다. 다음 담당자는 차별 금지 정책과 관련된 문의를 처리하도록 지정되었습니다. Bryan Miller, Title IX Coordinator; 204 W. South Street Leander, TX 78646; Bryan.Miller@Leanderisd.org; (512) 570-0000

В Leander ISD не допускается дискриминация по признаку расы, цвета кожи, национального происхождения, пола или инвалидности в ходе реализации программ профессиональной подготовки или сопряженных с ней мероприятий, и обеспечивается равный доступ представителям бойскаутских и других молодежных организаций. Запросы относительно реализации правил о недопущении дискриминации рассматриваются специалистом: Брайан Миллер, координатор по соблюдению Раздела IX; 204 W. South Street Leander, TX 78646; Bryan.Miller@Leanderisd.org; (512) 570-0000.

VISTA RIDGE HIGH SCHOOL · RANGERS

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